Eliott **THOMAS**

PhD Candidate in Document AI · Machine Learning Researcher



I work on **reliable information extraction** from business documents when labeled data is scarce, using semi-supervised and active learning, uncertainty estimation, and zero-shot methods. Final-year industrial (CIFRE) PhD between La Rochelle University (L3i) and Yooz, with **7 papers accepted at WACV & ICDAR** and methods **running in production**. Defending December 2026, and looking for an applied-research role in a field where reliable AI matters, ideally health or environment.

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La Rochelle, France · open to Paris & remote · French citizen

EXPERIENCE

Research Engineer, CIFRE PhD — Jan 2024 – Present
Yooz × L3i Lab (La Rochelle University), France

- Lead the research on **table extraction under scarce supervision** at Yooz, an AP-automation SaaS company (600+ employees): semi-supervised learning, active learning, zero-shot LLM methods, and uncertainty estimation.
- **5 papers accepted at WACV & ICDAR** (2025–2026), plus one journal article under review on prediction rejection.
- Moved research into Yooz's **production pipeline**, now extracting data from customer business documents at scale.
- Supervise and mentor research interns (3 at Yooz, 2 at L3i).

Research Engineer, Labcom IDEAS — Jan – Dec 2023
L3i Lab, La Rochelle University, France

- Information extraction from administrative and business documents. Co-authored **2 ICDAR 2023 papers** on key–value pair extraction and subgraph-induced extraction.

Final-Year Project: NLP for Crisis Response — May – Dec 2022
LITIS Lab, Rouen, France

- Fine-tuned French BERT-family models for multi-label classification of tweets posted after industrial disasters, on a corpus annotated by the team.

Teaching: Machine Learning & CS — 2023 – Present
EIGSI & La Rochelle University, France

- *Machine Learning 2* (M2, EIGSI, 2024–2025) · *Introduction to Web* (L2, 2026) · *Computer Science* lectures, tutorials & labs (L1, 2023).

EDUCATION

PhD in Artificial Intelligence (CIFRE) — 2024 – 2026
La Rochelle University · L3i Lab, France

Reliable table extraction in business documents under limited labeled data. Defense: December 2026.

Engineering Degree in CS + M.Sc. Data & AI — 2019 – 2022
ENSSAT Lannion, France · Université de Sherbrooke, Canada

Dual-degree programme, with the final year in Canada specialising in machine learning and data science. Both diplomas awarded the same year.

Classe Préparatoire (Maths Spé) — 2017 – 2019
Lycée Dupuy de Lôme, Lorient, France

Intensive mathematics and physics track for engineering schools.

PUBLICATIONS

- **ICDAR 2026** ConRTF: Edge-Constrained Boundary Distribution Refinement for Real-time Transformer Table Structure Recognition
- **ICDAR 2026** Active Learning for Cascaded Object Detection: Balancing Coverage and Uncertainty in Table Extraction Pipelines
- **WACV 2026** Zero-Shot Table Extraction in Business Documents: A Unified Benchmark with Error Taxonomy and Ecological Analysis
- **ICDAR 2025** QUEST: Quality-aware Semi-supervised Table Extraction for Business Documents
- **WACV 2025** RAPTOR: Refined Approach for Product Table Object Recognition
- **ICDAR 2023** SETI: Subgraph-Induced Extraction Technique for Information from Administrative Documents
- **ICDAR 2023** Extracting Key-Value Pairs in Business Documents

SKILLS

Machine Learning
PyTorch · Hugging Face Transformers · computer vision (object detection, table structure recognition) · NLP · LLMs & zero-shot inference · semi-supervised & active learning · uncertainty estimation & prediction confidence · fine-tuning · scikit-learn

Engineering
Python · SQL · R · Docker · Git · Linux · HPC cluster computing & administration · LaTeX

LANGUAGES

French	Native
English	Professional fluency (C1)
Spanish	Intermediate (B1)

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY

- **Vice-President then Treasurer, ADocs** (2024–2025), the doctoral students' association (∼100 members), where I managed the budget.
- **Founded the PhD Club at L3i**, a weekly meet-up where a student presents anything useful to fellow PhDs (outside their own research topic).
- **HPC server administrator**, L3i Lab (2023–present).
- **Member, University Research Commission**, La Rochelle University (2025–present).
- **Treasurer, TSEL** student sports tournament (2020–2021).

INTERESTS

Running · Fitness · Badminton · Cinema